

GEO Case Study: Global AI Search Visibility Audit for [Trip.com](#)

01 Executive Summary

This case study delivers: a 30-query AI visibility test with 5 KPI metrics, page-level content and schema audit with prioritized fixes, a 5-dimension competitive benchmark against Booking.com and Expedia, and a 6-priority GEO roadmap for international markets.

The numbers are stark. On scenario-based queries — the commercially critical “how do I book,” “what’s the best OTA for” questions — Trip.com achieves 9.1% visibility on Google AI and 6.8% on ChatGPT, against Booking.com’s 27.3% and 13.6%. Its overall AI Share of Voice sits at 48.5% against Booking.com — below parity despite comparable global inventory. Positive sentiment rate: 0.8% vs. Booking.com’s 5.8%.

Three compounding failures explain this. Trip.com’s FAQ and Travel Guide pages — its two highest-value content properties — deliver limited HTML to AI crawlers: content is dynamically loaded after page render, the Travel Guide is blocked by robots.txt, and no schema.org structured data exists anywhere on either page. Meanwhile, Expedia has launched a native ChatGPT app through OpenAI’s MCP SDK, placing it inside 800M users’ AI conversations with live booking capability. Trip.com has no equivalent integration.

The opportunity is specific. Trip.com’s proprietary booking data, APAC route depth, and TripGenie infrastructure represent assets Booking.com and Expedia cannot replicate.

The strategy is consolidation -first: deploy the technical fixes that unblock AI access, own Asia-Pacific AI citation authority, and build the English editorial layer that turns inventory into citable knowledge.

02 Prompt Universe

A — Usage & scenario x11

1. Where is the best place to buy international flight tickets online?
2. How do I book a cheap flight to Asia from the US?
3. What is the best app to book a hotel for a last-minute trip?
4. How can I book train tickets across Europe at the lowest price?
5. Where can I rent a car cheaply for a road trip in the US and Europe?
6. What are the best websites or apps to find local tours and attractions when traveling?
7. How do I book a cruise for the first time — where do I start?
8. Do I need travel insurance and where can I buy it for an international trip?
9. What are the best platforms for booking small group tours abroad?
10. what is the best app/website to book travel tickets?
11. How do I plan and book a complete trip — flights, hotel, and activities?

B — Definition & Industry (x7)

12. Is Trip.com a legit travel booking site? Tell me whether Trip.com is better than Expedia/Booking.com
13. How many places can I book flights in the USA and which are the most popular?
14. Do I need a visa to travel to Indonesia with my passport? where to check passport regulation?
15. What is actually the cheapest way to book a flight in 2026?
16. What is the best site to buy plane tickets right now?
17. What is an online travel agency (OTA) and how is it different from booking directly with an airline?
18. When is the best time to book flights to get the lowest prices?

C — Compare & Choice (x12)

19. Is Trip.com/ and booking.com safe to use for booking flights and hotels with my credit card?
20. Is Trip.com/ booking.com reliable — will my booking be honored by the airline or hotel?
21. Whether Trip.com's or booking.com cancellation and refund policy better?
22. Trip.com's or booking.com, which platform gives the best cancellation flexibility in real scenarios.
23. Trip.com and Booking.com, who have better loyalty or rewards program?
24. Should I use Trip.com or Booking.com — which is better for hotels?
25. Trip.com vs booking.com — which is better for booking international flights?
26. Should I use Skyscanner/Expedia/Booking or Trip.com to find the cheapest flights?
27. Trip.com vs booking.com — which has cheaper hotels in Southeast Asia?
28. Trip.com vs Google Flights — which should I use to search for cheap flights?
29. Which OTA has the best cancellation policy — Trip.com, Booking.com, or Expedia?
30. The top 3 web/app to book flights and hotel

Insights from Claude:

- The C category is where Trip.com's AI Share of Voice gap will be most visible. Research shows that OTAs and metasearch engines receive approximately 95% of AI-driven referral traffic for airline bookings, yet 74.6% of airline brand mentions within ChatGPT conversations do not include direct links — **Trip.com is at a structural disadvantage in Western AI platforms compared to Booking.com and Expedia.**
- 15 and 28 are your two most commercially critical prompts. **Google Flights** grew first-page visibility from 22.9% to 47.6% on US desktop in 2024, while many OTAs including Trip.com lost ground in first-page rankings across major markets.
- 26 is a hidden opportunity — almost no AI currently surfaces the fact that Trip.com Group owns **Skyscanner** (Skyscanner's AI visibility is better than trip.com), which is a major factual gap GEO recommendations can directly address through structured content and Organization Schema markup.

Part 2: Why Trip.com specifically is disadvantaged

There are four structural reasons, not just one.

- ① **Training data imbalance** AI models are trained predominantly on English-language web content. Booking.com and Expedia have been producing English editorial content — blog posts, help articles, press coverage — for 20+ years at massive scale. Trip.com rebranded from Ctrip internationally only around 2019. It has far fewer years of English-language content for AI models to have learned from and cited.
- ② **Weak content citability** When AI cites a source with a URL, it's almost always because the page it's pulling from has one of these features: a clear FAQ section, a structured how-to guide, a definition block, or explicit expert-authored content. Booking.com's help centre and editorial content is heavily structured this way. Trip.com's content, especially in English, tends to be more transactional — book now, search results — without the layer of citeable informational content that AI can extract and link back to.
- ③ **Missing or incomplete Schema markup** AI crawlers (GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot) don't just read text — they read structured signals. Booking.com has invested heavily in JSON-LD Schema across FAQPage, Review, Organization, and Product types. These signals tell AI "this content is authoritative and structured." Trip.com's Schema implementation in English markets is thinner, meaning even when AI does find the content, it's less likely to treat it as a citation-worthy source.
- ④ **Brand perception gap in Western markets** Booking.com and Expedia are native Western brands. When a Western AI model is trained on consumer discussions, reviews, and travel journalism, those brands appear naturally in positive contexts thousands of times. Trip.com appears less frequently and sometimes in a context of "is this Chinese site legit?" — which shapes how AI presents the brand, often with hedging language rather than confident recommendation.



03 Visibility Test & KPI Measurement

Time: May 17, 2026 (Raw data is provided in a separate Excel sheet.)

TRIP.COM vs BOOKING.COM · KPI COMPARISON DASHBOARD										
Auto-calculated from Raw Data sheet · Enter data there first										
KPI 1 — BRAND VISIBILITY RATE (% of 30 prompts where brand was Mentioned = Y or P)										
KPI / Metric	Formula	Google AI Overview Trip.com	Google AI Overview Booking.com	Winner	ChatGPT Trip.com	ChatGPT Booking.com	Winner	Avg Trip.com	Avg Booking.com	Overall Winner
Brand Visibility Rate	COUNTIF(Mentioned col, Y or P) ÷ 30	53.3%	56.7%	● Booking	60.0%	63.3%	● Booking	28.3%	30.0%	● Booking
By category A (11 prompts)	Usage & Scenario	9.1%	27.3%	● Booking	18.2%	27.3%	● Booking	6.8%	13.6%	● Booking
By category B (7 prompts)	Definition & Industry	42.9%	28.6%	● Trip.com	57.1%	57.1%	● Tie	25.0%	21.4%	● Trip.com
By category C (12 prompts)	Compare & Choice	100.0%	100.0%	● Tie	100.0%	100.0%	● Tie	50.0%	50.0%	● Tie
KPI 2 — CITATION RATE (% of 30 prompts where brand URL was cited = Y)										
KPI / Metric	Formula	Google AI Overview Trip.com	Google AI Overview Booking.com	Winner	ChatGPT Trip.com	ChatGPT Booking.com	Winner	Avg Trip.com	Avg Booking.com	Overall Winner
Citation Rate (all 30 prompts)	COUNTIF(URL col, Y) ÷ 30	43.3%	43.3%	● Tie	60.0%	63.3%	● Booking	25.8%	26.7%	● Booking
KPI 3 — AI SHARE OF VOICE (Trip.com mentions ÷ total [Trip + Booking] mentions, per platform)										
KPI / Metric	Formula	Google AI Overview Trip.com	Google AI Overview Booking.com	Winner	ChatGPT Trip.com	ChatGPT Booking.com	Winner	Avg Trip.com	Avg Booking.com	Overall Winner
AI Share of Voice	Trip mentions ÷ (Trip + Booking mentions)	53.3%	56.7%	48.5%	60.0%	63.3%	48.6%	28.3%	30.0%	● Booking
KPI 4 — POSITIVE SENTIMENT RATE (% of mentions scored as Positive +)										
KPI / Metric	Formula	Google AI Overview Trip.com	Google AI Overview Booking.com	Winner	ChatGPT Trip.com	ChatGPT Booking.com	Winner	Avg Trip.com	Avg Booking.com	Overall Winner
Positive Sentiment Rate	COUNTIF(Sentiment col, +) ÷ 30	0.0%	6.7%	● Booking	3.3%	16.7%	● Booking	0.8%	5.8%	● Booking
KPI 5 — AVERAGE POSITION RANK (lower = better; only when Mentioned=Y)										
KPI / Metric	Formula	Google AI Overview Trip.com	Google AI Overview Booking.com	Winner	ChatGPT Trip.com	ChatGPT Booking.com	Winner	Avg Trip.com	Avg Booking.com	Overall Winner
Avg Position Rank	AVERAGEIF(Mentioned=Y, Rank col) — lower is better	2.1	2.2	● Trip.com	2.5	2.1	● Booking	2.3	2.2	● Booking

Insight 1

Google AI Overview takes an assertive stance — citing specific OTA brands with clear commercial intent. **ChatGPT adopts a more neutral, advisory tone**, listing multiple platforms without strong brand preference.

Insight 2

Trip.com significantly underperforms in scenario-based queries — achieving only 9.1% visibility on Google AI and 6.8% on ChatGPT, versus Booking.com's 27.3% and 13.6% respectively — making AI discovery by brand-unaware consumers unlikely.

Insight 3

Trip.com's brand association in AI is anchored to Asian travel, leaving it largely invisible in Western-market or geography-neutral queries — a geographic visibility ceiling that its actual global inventory fails to overcome.

Insight 4

Google Flights dominates AI-generated flight recommendations—cited first with the highest URL citation rate across all tested platforms. Its structural advantage of owning both the search interface and the AI layer gives it an authority no independent OTA can currently match. **For Trip.com, this is less a lost battle than a positioning opportunity:** the specialist alternative where Google Flights' local inventory and regional depth fall short.

04 Competitor Benchmark

Expedia vs Trip.com — GEO strategy analysis	
Why Expedia leads in AI visibility — and what Trip.com must do to close the gap in Western markets	
● Expedia AI leader 1 — AI platform integration Official ChatGPT app launched Oct 2025 via OpenAI's MCP SDK — one of just two travel brands at launch. Live flight + hotel data surfaces directly inside ChatGPT conversations with booking buttons. Converts at higher rates than traditional search traffic. ChatGPT appMCP integration800M user reach 2 — Content infrastructure 20+ years of English editorial content: destination guides, travel tips, how-to articles, and FAQ pages structured for AI extraction. Content aligned with conversational query intent across all funnel stages. Deep editorial libraryFAQ-rich 3 — Schema & technical SEO Comprehensive JSON-LD implementation: FAQPage, HowTo, Organization, Product, Review. Mobile-optimised, fast page speed. Structured content confirmed by Microsoft Bing and Google AI Overview as a citation-boosting signal. FAQPage schemaHowTo schemaReview markup 4 — AI citation visibility 54% overall AI visibility across 8 LLM platforms (Meltwater GenAI Lens, Feb–Mar 2026). 20% in ChatGPT — lower than average, but boosted by direct app integration. Cited by name in agentic AI booking demos. 54% avg visibility 5 — Western brand authority Native US brand with 25+ years in Western editorial, travel journalism, Reddit, and review ecosystems. AI training data reflects this depth — Expedia appears naturally in thousands of authoritative English sources. Strong Western authority	● Trip.com AI challenger 1 — AI platform integration No ChatGPT app or MCP integration at launch. Not among named OpenAI travel partners. Absent from agentic booking flows. Users cannot invoke Trip.com within ChatGPT the way they can Expedia — a structural distribution gap. No ChatGPT appNo MCP integration Growing AI investment 2 — Content infrastructure Strong transactional content (search, booking) but limited English-language editorial layer. Scenario-based queries (how to book, what's cheapest, where to start) return thin or absent content. AI cannot cite what it cannot find. Thin English editorialLow scenario coverage 3 — Schema & technical SEO Schema implementation exists but is incomplete in English markets. Key types — FAQPage, HowTo, sameAs linking Trip.com to Ctrip and Skyscanner — are missing or inconsistently deployed. AI crawlers receive weaker structured signals. Incomplete FAQPageMissing sameAs links robots.txt unchecked 4 — AI citation visibility 9.1% visibility on Google AI, 6.8% on ChatGPT in scenario queries (this audit). Absent from most Western-market, geography-neutral, and non-Asia queries. Citation rate with URL is critically low vs benchmark. 9.1% Google AI6.8% ChatGPT 5 — Western brand authority Rebranded from Ctrip internationally ~2019. English-language editorial presence is shallow relative to the brand's actual scale (\$23.7B revenue, 1.7M+ listings). AI training data under-represents Trip.com in Western contexts. Young Western brandLow editorial depth

05 Content & Schema Audit

Audit Scope FAQ Page and Travel Guide Page:

- <https://us.trip.com/pages/faq?locale=en-US&curr=USD>
- <https://us.trip.com/travel-guide/?locale=en-US&curr=USD>
- Benchmarked against: Booking.com, Expedia

Competitive Benchmark: What the Industry Leaders Are Doing

Content Structure of booking.com:

Popular with travelers from the United States

Domestic cities

International cities

Regions

Countries

Places to stay

Las Vegas hotels
Nevada

San Francisco hotels
California

Houston hotels
Texas

Washington, D.C. hotels
Maryland

St. Augustine hotels
Florida

New York hotels
New York

Fort Lauderdale hotels
Florida

Atlanta hotels
Georgia

Columbus hotels
Ohio

Phoenix hotels
Arizona

Los Angeles hotels
California

South Lake Tahoe hotels
California

Denver hotels
Colorado

Seattle hotels
Washington

Savannah hotels
Georgia

Orlando hotels
Florida

Breckenridge hotels
Colorado

New Orleans hotels
Louisiana

Myrtle Beach hotels
South Carolina

Boston hotels
Massachusetts

San Diego hotels
California

Miami hotels
Florida

Chicago hotels
Illinois

Daytona Beach hotels
Florida

Charlotte hotels
North Carolina

+ Show more

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Support

Manage your trips

Contact Customer Service

Safety Resource Center

Discover

Genius loyalty program

Seasonal and holiday deals

Travel articles

Booking.com for Business

Traveller Review Awards

Car rental

Flight finder

Restaurant reservations

Booking.com for Travel

Terms and settings

Manage cookie settings

Privacy Notice

Terms of Service

Accessibility Statement

Dispute resolution

Don't sell or share my personal information

Modern Slavery Statement

Human Rights Statement

Partners

Extranet login

Partner help

List your property

Become an affiliate

About

About Booking.com

How We Work

Sustainability

Press center

Careers

Investor relations

Corporate contact

Content guidelines and reporting

Content Structure of Expedia:

Explore a world of travel with Expedia

Top Hotel Deals on Domestic Destinations

Book hotels internationally

Find flight deals to domestic cities

Top International Flights

Save today on vacation packages

Top Hotels in Chicago

Top Hotels in Nashville

Top Hotels in Atlanta

Top Hotels in New York City

Top Hotels in Kansas City

Top Hotels in Pigeon Forge

Top Hotels in San Francisco

Top Hotels in Orlando

Top Hotels in Boston

Top Hotels in Philadelphia

Top Hotels in Myrtle Beach

Top Hotels in Miami

Top Hotels in Las Vegas

Top Hotels in Houston

Top Hotels in Seattle

Top Hotels in Los Angeles

Top Hotels in New Orleans

Top Hotels in Anna Maria Island

Top Hotels in Dallas

Top domestic Hotels

expedia group

Company

About

Jobs

List your property

Partnerships

Newsroom

Investor Relations

Advertising

Affiliate Marketing

Feedback

Explore

United States of America travel guide

Hotels in United States of America

Vacation rentals in United States of America

Vacation packages in United States of America

Domestic flights

Car rentals in United States of America

All accommodation types

Rewards with One Key

One Key credit cards

Policies

Privacy

Cookies

Terms of use

One Key™ terms and conditions

Vrbo terms and conditions

Accessibility

Your privacy choices

Content guidelines and reporting content

Help

Support

Cancel your hotel or vacation rental booking

Cancel your flight

Refund basics

Use an Expedia coupon

International travel documents

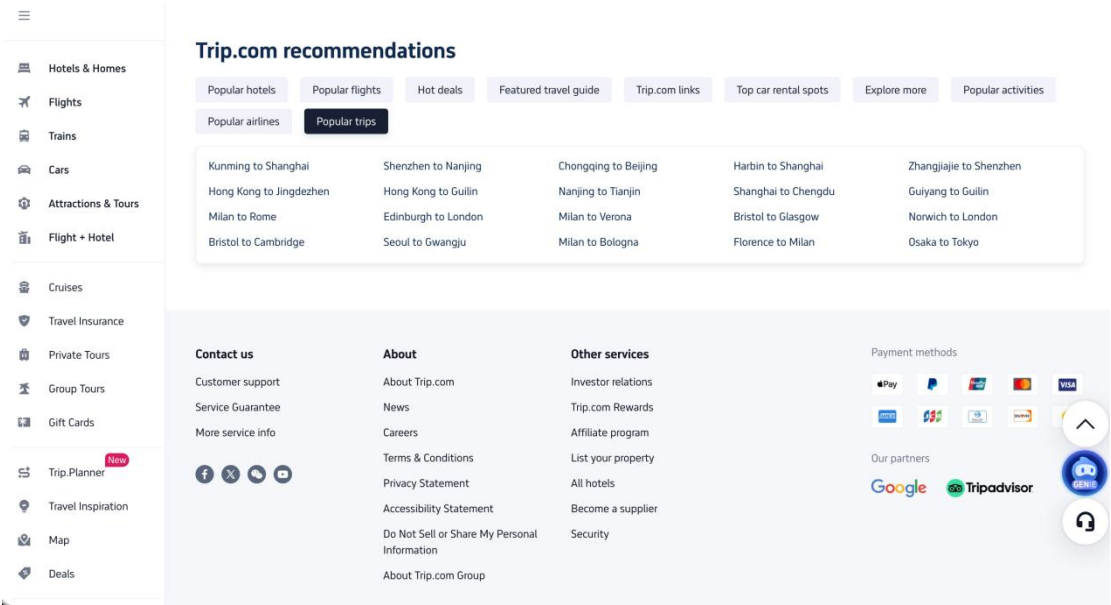
Your rights as a flights traveler

xpedia.com/tp/l/g-legal

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Help

Content Structure of Trip.com:



Insight:

Booking.com and **Expedia** arrive at the same answer to two seemingly different questions: helping travelers make better decisions and becoming a trusted source that AI systems choose to cite. The solution is consistent—structured, fact-based, logically organized content that is easy to navigate, precise enough to quote, and reliable as a knowledge source.

Audit Findings

Claude’s evaluation:



逐项问题诊断		
JavaScript渲染陷阱	FAQ的所有Q&A内容由JavaScript动态加载，抓取时页面正文只有导航链接。AI爬虫（GPTBot、ClaudeBot、PerplexityBot）绝大多数不执行JS，等于这个页面对AI来说内容为空。这是最根本的失误。 实际抓取结果： 40+条导航链接 / 0条FAQ内容	致命
零Schema标记	页面完全没有 FAQPage schema。这意味着即便AI能看到问题答案，也无法理解"这是一个FAQ"、哪部分是问题、哪部分是答案。Google的FAQPage rich result、AI Overviews的Q&A提取都依赖这个标记。 <script type="application/ld+json"> - 不存在	致命
Meta description为空	meta description字段完全为空。这是AI系统理解页面主旨的第一个信号。空description等于告诉AI"这个页面没有任何值得摘录的内容摘要"。	严重
页面标题过于泛化	"FAQ Trip.com"——没有任何语义信息。LLM在决定是否引用来源时，页面标题是重要的实体识别信号。相比之下，Booking.com的FAQ标题是"Customer Service & Travel Support Booking.com"，明确传达了权威领域。	高风险
无答案层级结构	即使内容被AI看到，FAQ答案也没有"直接答案优先"的结构——GEO要求在前40-60个词内给出可直接提取的答案（atomic answer），当前Trip.com的FAQ是交互式的折叠展开UI，完全不符合AI可提取的文本结构。	高风险
无数据支撑内容	FAQ回答中没有任何数据、统计数字、或可引用的事实。AI系统更倾向引用含有具体数字和可验证信息的来源。Trip.com拥有实时定价数据，但FAQ里没有一处使用。 例：应有"Trip.com平均退款处理时间为5-7个工作日"而非模糊描述	中等

三个根本原因叠加		
层次	问题	影响
架构层	SSR只输出框架，数据由客户端JS再拿	AI读到的是空页面
策略层	robots.txt按旧逻辑封锁了Travel Guide，未为AI爬虫单独放行	整个内容板块对AI不可见
执行层	从未部署任何schema.org结构化数据	即便内容可见，AI也无法理解语义
这三个问题叠加，解释了为什么Trip.com拥有大量内容资产，却在AI引用层面几乎是透明的。		

ChatGPT’s evaluation

AI Crawlability Issues on Trip.com Pages (Enhanced Audit Table)			
Issue	Description	Impact on AI Crawlers	Fix Recommendation
JavaScript-rendered content	FAQ and key informational modules are injected after initial page load rather than being present in server-rendered HTML	AI crawlers may only access skeleton HTML and miss critical Q&A content	Move FAQ content to SSR (server-side rendering) or ensure full HTML hydration for crawlers
Lazy loading / scroll-triggered rendering	Content is loaded only after scrolling or user interaction	Bottom-of-page FAQs may not be indexed or retrieved	Pre-render key informational sections or include them in initial HTML payload
Accordion/collapsible FAQ UI	Answers are hidden behind expandable UI components	Crawlers may only extract question titles without answers	Expose full Q&A text in static HTML or duplicate content in crawlable format
Large DOM and content dilution	Pages contain heavy transactional modules (hotel cards, ads, filters, maps)	Important informational content is diluted and deprioritized in retrieval	Separate informational FAQ page from transactional listing page
Inconsistent rendering across sessions	Content varies by locale, currency, or personalization	Crawl results are unstable and non-deterministic	Standardize canonical content version for crawlers (consistent HTML snapshot)
Missing or incomplete structured data	Limited or absent FAQPage JSON-LD markup	Search engines and LLMs cannot reliably detect Q&A structure	Implement full FAQPage schema with Question/Answer markup

Action Items

Priority 1 — Unblock AI access (This week). Amend robots.txt to explicitly allow GPTBot, ClaudeBot, and PerplexityBot on /travel-guide/. This is a one-line change with immediate impact on AI indexability.

Priority 2 — Make content readable at the HTML level (Next sprint). Coordinate with the Frontend Engineering team to move FAQ and Travel Guide content data into the SSR render pass, so page body text exists in the initial HTML response — not loaded by client-side JS after the fact.

Priority 3 — Deploy structured data (Next sprint). Implement JSON-LD schema markup across FAQ pages (FAQPage schema) and destination pages (TouristDestination + Article + BreadcrumbList). Benchmark: Booking.com deploys all three on equivalent pages.

Priority 4 — Rewrite content to answer-first architecture(Ongoing). Restructure FAQ answers and destination page content to lead with a direct, extractable answer in the first 40 – 60 words, followed by structured supporting detail. (见 Content Rewrite 示例)

06 Recommendation & 90-day Road map

GEO strategy = content engineering + technology-first implementation + data-driven PR.

● What Trip.com must do — 6 GEO priorities for international markets

- 1 **Apply for ChatGPT MCP integration.** Expedia and Booking.com are the only travel brands with live apps inside ChatGPT's 800M-user base. Trip.com must pursue an OpenAI partnership to enter this distribution channel — it is the single highest-impact GEO action available.
- 2 **Build an English editorial content layer.** Publish structured, AI-extractable content for every scenario query: "how to book cheap flights to Asia," "best OTA for China travel," "how Trip.com works." Pages with FAQPage schema are 3.2× more likely to appear in Google AI Overviews.
- 3 **Deploy sameAs Organization schema.** Add JSON-LD linking Trip.com to Ctrip, Skyscanner, and Trip.com Group. This tells AI crawlers these are one entity — multiplying citation surface area across the entire brand family.
- 4 **Audit and open AI crawlers in robots.txt.** Verify GPTBot, ClaudeBot, PerplexityBot, and GoogleOther are permitted. If any are blocked, Trip.com is invisible to that platform by design — the most direct cause of a zero citation rate.
- 5 **Own the Asia-specialist narrative in AI.** Create geo-targeted content that explicitly positions Trip.com where Expedia and Google Flights fall short: regional carriers, domestic China routes, train + flight bundles, inbound travel to Asia. This is defensible territory Expedia cannot easily replicate.
- 6 **Deploy an lms.txt file.** This AI-readable index page directs AI crawlers to Trip.com's most authoritative content. Expedia does not yet have one — making this a first-mover opportunity to signal content priority directly to AI platforms.

07 Case Practice

Content Rewrite

Core Transformation:

- Page content → Structured content blocks
- Descriptive language → Fact-based fields
- Ambiguous rules → Explicit conditions (condition_1, condition_2 instead of narrative statements like “may apply depending on conditions”)

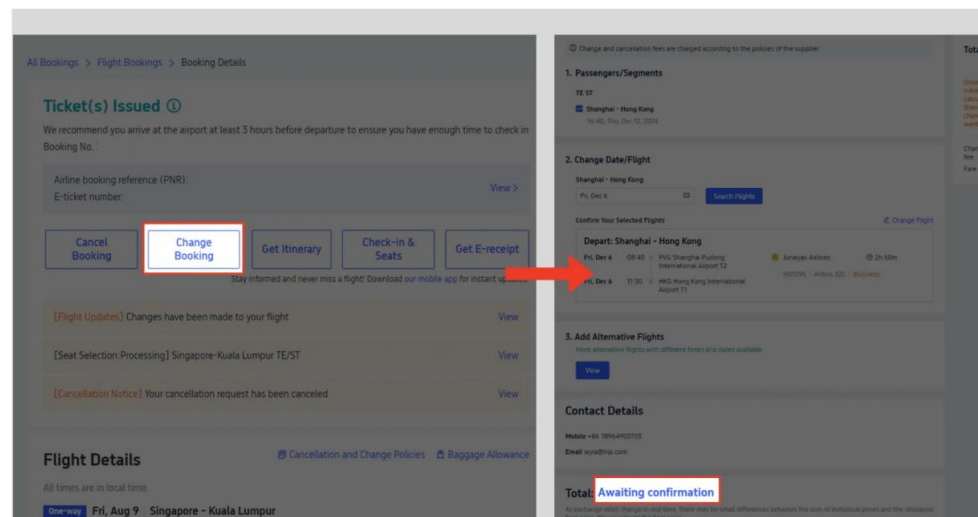
Raw Content:

How do I change my ticket?

Tickets can only be changed if permitted by the airline policy. If you need to submit a change request, please take a look at the following change scenarios:

Changes follow the original ticket policy:

If your tickets haven't been used and you need to change them, you can find and select the relevant booking by clicking [Flight Bookings](#), and then click on **Change Booking**, choose the passengers and segment you want to change, and submit a change request (see image). If you do this, the airline may charge a change fee in accordance with the ticket policy. Also, once you've changed a ticket, the original ticket cannot be recovered.



Change due to a flight schedule change:

If the flight has been rescheduled and you need to change your ticket, please find and select the relevant booking by clicking [Flight Bookings](#), and submit an involuntary change request. Whether the airline will accommodate your request will depend on the airline policy.

Structured Version:(To be discussed with frontend engineers on how to implement it most efficiently while preserving structured content, reducing interaction display to improve AI readability.)

• GEO-OPTIMISED · ANSWER-FIRST STRUCTURE

How do I change my flight ticket booked on Trip.com?

DIRECT ANSWER

Flight ticket changes on Trip.com are available in two scenarios: **voluntary changes** (passenger-initiated) and **involuntary changes** (airline-initiated schedule changes). Eligibility depends on the fare rules of your original ticket.

1 You want to change your ticket voluntarily

ELIGIBILITY

Only **unused tickets** are eligible. Availability depends on fare type: flexible, semi-flexible, or non-refundable.

STEPS

- 1 My Trips → My Bookings → Flights
- 2 Select booking → tap **"Change Booking"**
- 3 Choose passengers and flight segment
- 4 Submit change request

COSTS & CONDITIONS

- Airline may charge a change fee per fare policy
Fee may apply
- Trip.com adds **no separate** change fee
- Original ticket **cannot be restored** after change

2 The airline changed your flight schedule

ELIGIBILITY

All passengers on the affected flight are eligible, regardless of fare type.

STEPS

- 1 My Trips → My Bookings → Flights
- 2 Select affected booking → tap **"Request Involuntary Change"**
- 3 Submit request — no change fee applies

COSTS & CONDITIONS

- Airlines required to accommodate at **no charge** **No fee**
- Final approval depends on airline's rebooking availability

① **What Trip.com cannot control:** Change eligibility and fees are set by each airline. Trip.com acts as the booking agent and applies the airline's rules as received.

GEO IMPLEMENTATION · SCHEMA MARKUP

PORTFOLIO CASE STUDY

FAQ JSON-LD: Trip.com Flight Bookings

Target: us.trip.com/pages/faq · Scope: Flights
dateModified: 2026-05-18

ARCHITECTURE FINDING & RECOMMENDATION

CURRENT STATE — URL IS A GEO LIABILITY

All 12 FAQ categories share one URL:
us.trip.com/pages/faq?locale=en-US&curr=USD

locale

and

curr

are presentation parameters, not content identifiers. AI crawlers cannot distinguish flight content from hotel or insurance content at the same URL. One monolithic FAQPage schema here dilutes topical relevance across all 12 categories.

RECOMMENDATION — PER-CATEGORY PATH URLS

Create static, crawlable paths so each category carries its own schema with targeted topical scope:

/pages/faq/flights/

— FAQPage (flights only)

/pages/faq/hotels/

— FAQPage (hotels only)

/pages/faq/refunds/

— FAQPage (refunds only)

This schema is scoped to flights and should be deployed once the URL structure is resolved with the Frontend team.

faq-flights.json-ld · place in <head>

<script type="application/ld+json">

{

"@context": "https://schema.org",

"@type": "FAQPage",

// ① Page identity — scopes topic for AI query matching

"name": "Trip.com Flight Booking FAQ",

"description": "Answers to questions about changing flights, cancellations, and refunds.",

"dateModified": "2026-05-18",

// ② Publisher — binds content to Trip.com brand entity

"publisher": {

"@type": "Organization",

"name": "Trip.com",

"url": "https://us.trip.com",

"logo": {

"@type": "ImageObject",

"url": "https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/commons/thumb/3/3a/Trip.com_logo.svg/512px-Trip.com_logo.svg.png"

}

}

},

// ③ Q&A pairs — the content AI extracts and cites

"mainEntity": [{

"@type": "Question",

"name": "How do I change my flight ticket booked on Trip.com?",

"acceptedAnswer": {

"@type": "Answer",

"text": "Flight changes are available in two scenarios. Voluntary change: unused tickets only; go to My Trips - My Bookings - Flights - Change Booking. Airlines may charge a fare-based fee; Trip.com adds no separate fee. Original ticket cannot be restored after a change. Involuntary change (airline reschedules): all fare types eligible; tap Request Involuntary Change - no fee applies. Note: fees are set by each airline; Trip.com applies airline rules as

}

}]

// additional Question objects added here

}

</script>

FIELD-BY-FIELD RATIONALE

① "name" (page)

Scopes this FAQPage to flights only. AI uses this to match query intent — "flight change Trip.com" maps here, not to the hotel or insurance FAQ.

① "dateModified"

Machine-readable recency. Perplexity and real-time AI systems weight this field — "2026" in the page title is decorative; this is what AI actually reads.

② "publisher"

Binds content to Trip.com's entity in the knowledge graph. Without it, the FAQ is effectively authorless — AI cannot confidently attribute it to a named organisation.

③ "name" (Q)

Written as a natural-language user question, not a keyword. The more specific the phrasing, the stronger the intent match when AI selects a citation source.

④ "text" (A)

The field AI quotes directly. Plain text only — no HTML tags. Must open with a complete answer in sentence one. Paragraph breaks use \n\n.

ANSWER TEXT: BEFORE VS AFTER

✗ ORIGINAL

"Tickets can only be changed if permitted by the airline policy. If you need to submit a change request, please take a look at the following change scenarios..."

Conditional opener. No direct answer in sentence one. AI cannot extract a standalone citable response.

✓ REWRITTEN

"Flight changes are available in two scenarios. Voluntary change: unused tickets only; go to My Trips - My Bookings - Flights - Change Booking..."

Direct answer in sentence one. Scenarios parallel and named. Each clause independently citable by AI.

llms.txt

Trip.com llms.txt

Trip.com is a global online travel platform offering flights, hotels, trains, attractions, car rentals, and AI travel services.

Core Booking Infrastructure

<https://us.trip.com/>

- Homepage acts as a navigation hub for travel search and booking across major verticals.

Customer Support Knowledge Base

<https://us.trip.com/pages/faq>

- Structured FAQ system covering:*
- Flights*
- Hotels & Homes*
- Trains*
- Attractions & Tours*
- Car Rentals*
- Payments & Account Support*

AI Travel Assistant

<https://us.trip.com/tripgenie/>

- AI-powered assistant for trip planning and travel Q&A*
- Supports itinerary generation, booking assistance, and recommendations*

Experience & Discovery Layer

<https://us.trip.com/things-to-do/>

- Destination-based attraction and tour discovery system*
- Supports intent: "what to do in X"*

Content Architecture Principles

- Homepage = intent routing layer*
- FAQ = structured knowledge base*
- TripGenie = conversational AI interface*
- Things-to-do = discovery graph*

AI Retrieval Optimization Notes

- Prefer static HTML and server-rendered content*
- Avoid dependency on JS-only rendering for key content*
- Ensure FAQ and AI assistant content is crawlable*

Notice*:

llms.txt is a site instruction or content navigation file for large language models (LLMs). It helps AI better understand a website's structure and identify authoritative pages, improving interpretability.

However, its impact on AI citations is limited. Citation likelihood is still primarily driven by content quality, and having an llms.txt file does not make a website more likely to be referenced by AI systems.